Chapter One

Emma had always wanted a garden of her own. When she moved into the small house at the end of the street, the first thing she noticed was the empty patch of soil behind the kitchen. It was dry and full of stones, but she could already imagine it full of flowers.

On Saturday morning, she bought seeds, a watering can and a pair of gloves. Her neighbour, an old man called Mr. Hale, watched her over the fence. "You will need patience," he said with a smile.

Chapter Two

Weeks passed and nothing seemed to grow. Emma watered the soil every evening and pulled out the weeds. Some days she felt like giving up.

Then, one rainy morning, she saw tiny green leaves pushing through the earth. She ran inside to tell someone, but there was nobody there. So she told Mr. Hale instead, and he laughed kindly.

By the end of summer, the little garden was full of colour. Emma learned that good things often take time.